

# Frequently Asked Questions

## What to Expect When Working With Us

We know that hiring a contractor or designer is one of the biggest decisions you'll make for your home — and your peace of mind matters as much as the finished space. Below are the questions our clients ask most often, answered honestly so you know exactly what to expect at every stage.

---

### 1. How long does a typical renovation take, and what does the process actually look like?

Timelines vary by scope, but as a general guide: a single-room renovation (kitchen or primary bath) typically takes **8–14 weeks** of active construction, while a whole-home renovation can run **4–9 months**. These numbers don't include design and planning, which we build in upfront so there are no surprises once work begins.

Our process follows five clear phases:

1. **Discovery & Design** — We learn how you live, define scope and budget, and develop initial concepts.
2. **Design Development & Documentation** — Concepts become detailed drawings, material selections, and a finalized scope.
3. **Permitting & Pre-Construction** — We handle permit submissions, finalize the schedule, and order long-lead items.
4. **Construction** — Our team executes the build with scheduled milestones and regular walkthroughs.
5. **Final Walkthrough & Close-Out** — We review every detail together before handing over your finished home.

You'll receive a project schedule at kickoff and updates at every milestone, so you always know where things stand.

---

### 2. What happens if we run into unexpected issues once the walls are opened up?

This is one of the most common concerns, and a fair one — older homes especially can reveal things like outdated wiring, water damage, or structural surprises once demolition begins. Here's how we protect you:

- **We build a contingency into every budget** (typically 10–15%, depending on your home's age and condition) specifically to absorb these kinds of discoveries without derailing your project.
- **Nothing proceeds without your sign-off.** If we uncover a condition that changes cost or scope, we stop, explain the issue, present your options, and get written approval

before any additional work or spending happens.

- **You'll always know the "why."** We don't just deliver a change order — we show you what we found and walk through the reasoning behind the recommended fix.

The goal is simple: no financial surprises, ever. You stay in control of every decision.

---

### **3. How many rounds of design revisions do we get before construction begins?**

Our design process includes **two structured rounds of revisions** on your initial concept, giving you the chance to refine layout, finishes, and details until the design truly feels like yours. Most clients land on a design they love within these two rounds.

If you'd like additional revisions beyond that, we're glad to accommodate — this is simply billed at our standard design rate, since it reflects the additional time our design team invests. We'll always tell you clearly if a requested change would move you into that territory, so there's never a surprise on your invoice.

The reason we hold this structure is to protect your timeline: unlimited open-ended revisions are the single biggest cause of construction delays, and we'd rather help you get to a confident, final design efficiently.

---

### **4. Do I need to purchase materials and furniture myself, or do you handle that?**

We handle it — that's part of the value of working with us. Our team manages full procurement, including:

- Sourcing and ordering fixtures, finishes, cabinetry, tile, and hardware
- Coordinating delivery timing so materials arrive exactly when needed (not too early, not too late)
- Vetting quality and managing any manufacturer or vendor issues, returns, or damage claims
- Furniture and décor sourcing, if you'd like design services to extend beyond construction

You're welcome to bring your own pieces or specific items you love, and we'll happily incorporate them into the design. But you will never be left navigating vendor logistics, freight deliveries, or backorder issues on your own — that's our job, not yours.

---

### **5. Can I stay living in my home during the renovation?**

In many cases, yes — and we'll give you an honest, room-by-room assessment during planning so you know exactly what to expect. Factors that affect this include:

- **Scope:** A kitchen or bath remodel is often livable-in, especially with a temporary kitchen setup or alternate bathroom access.
- **Utilities:** If water, electrical, or HVAC will be down for extended periods, we'll flag this clearly in advance.
- **Dust and access containment:** We use containment barriers, negative air machines, and dedicated work-zone entrances to minimize disruption to the parts of your home not under construction.
- **Whole-home projects:** For larger renovations, temporary relocation is often more comfortable, and we'll help you plan around that if needed.

Whatever your situation, we'll tell you plainly — before you sign a contract, not after demolition starts — so you can plan your life around the project with confidence.

---

## 6. Are your team members and subcontractors fully licensed and insured?

Yes, without exception. This is non-negotiable for us, and you're right to ask.

- Our firm carries **general liability insurance** and **workers' compensation coverage**, and we can provide certificates of insurance upon request.
- Every subcontractor we bring onto your project is **independently licensed** (where required by your state/municipality) and **carries their own current insurance**, which we verify and keep on file before they ever set foot in your home.
- We are also happy to walk you through our licensing credentials and provide references from past clients so you can verify our track record directly.

Your home is a significant investment, and you should never have to wonder who's liable if something goes wrong. With us, that question is already answered.

---

## 7. How is pricing structured, and when do I know the final cost?

You'll receive a **detailed, itemized proposal** before any contract is signed — not a rough estimate. This breaks down design fees, construction costs, procurement, and the contingency reserve separately, so you can see exactly where your investment is going. The number you sign is the number we build to, with any changes handled through the transparent change-order process described above.

---

## 8. Who will I actually be talking to throughout the project?

You'll have a **single dedicated point of contact** — typically your project manager or lead designer — who owns communication from kickoff through final walkthrough. You won't be bounced between multiple people trying to piece together status updates. In addition,

we hold **regular scheduled check-ins** (typically weekly during active construction) so you always know what happened this week and what's coming next.

---

## 9. What happens if I'm not happy with something during construction?

Tell us right away — small concerns are far easier to address in the moment than after a phase is complete. Every milestone in our process includes a walkthrough specifically so issues can be caught and corrected before we move forward. Your satisfaction at each stage is a checkpoint, not an afterthought.

---

## 10. What happens after construction ends — is there a warranty?

Yes. We stand behind our work with a **workmanship warranty** (typically 1 year, with manufacturer warranties on fixtures and appliances extending further). If anything needs adjustment after move-in — a squeaky floorboard, a cabinet that needs re-aligning — we address it promptly. Our relationship doesn't end at final walkthrough; it's the beginning of you enjoying your new space.

---

*Have a question we didn't cover here? We're always happy to talk through your specific project in detail — reach out any time.*